



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brookside Academy

School Website: <https://brooksideacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Brookside Christian Academy (<https://brooksideacademy.com>) presents a clear classical Christian identity across its philosophy, mission, and curriculum pages. The site explicitly grounds learning in “truth, goodness, and beauty,” the Liberal Arts, and the Trivium/Quadrivium, and it highlights Latin and humanities with Scriptural integration—hallmark indicators of a classical school. Where the public materials are thinner is on pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, chanting/recitation, restful learning/scholé) and on faculty/parent-formation specifics. These gaps likely reflect a website content gap rather than a programmatic absence. Targeted updates (detailed below) would quickly move this school into a clear CLASSICAL designation on the public record.

Most important insights: - Strong classical foundations and purposes are clearly articulated (truth/goodness/beauty; formation in wisdom and virtue; theological integration). - Curriculum alignment is strong (Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, primary sources, humanities). - Public details about teaching methods (Socratic/seminar, chanting/recitation, restful learning) are not yet explicit; one summer-program page features “hands-on”/STEM language that is a weak negative signal in the classical lexicon (likely peripheral to core academics). - Hiring copy points the right direction (teachers mature in Christian faith; enthusiastic for classical education) but could add explicit “teacher as mentor/living curriculum” language.

School website audited: <https://brooksideacademy.com>

Method note: Keyword analysis used the positive/negative indicators from “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” and the companion lexicon organized by the six elements (religious/metaphysical, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, parents/community).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords found on school site:

- Positive matches: “truth, goodness, and beauty,” “God,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “image-bearers,” “Scripture integrated,” “reverence,” “order and beauty of creation”.
- Missing/limited: liturgy/chapel/psalmody/hymnody not publicly named.

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive indicators align with: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom (moral realism); theology and Scriptural integration; reverence (religious foundations).
- Minimal evidence for liturgical/communal practices (e.g., daily chapel) from public pages.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 10; Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage (of the subareas: moral realism, theology, liturgy): 0.67

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- The school explicitly professes transcendental moral realism (true/good/beautiful), integrates theology/Scripture, and evokes reverence, satisfying most criteria; liturgical practice is the only gap in public materials.
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords found:

- Positive matches: “cultivates virtue,” “develops wisdom,” “educate the whole child—mind, body, spirit,” “pursue Truth, recognize beauty, know good from evil,” “education is not merely a means to an end” (formation).

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive list: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; formation not mere information—all are explicitly present in BCA’s statements.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage: 1.00

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Purpose language is quintessentially classical, prioritizing wisdom/virtue and the transcendentals over utilitarian aims.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords found:

- Positive matches: “Liberal Arts,” “Trivium—the art of words,” “Quadrivium—the art of numbers,” “arithmetic, geometry, music, cosmos,” “Latin,” “humanities,” “history and literature,” “primary sources”.
- No “social studies” substitution; Great Books not named explicitly (primary sources and engagement with the Western tradition are indicated).

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive list: seven liberal arts; Great Books/primary sources; integrated/harmony of subjects; wonder/awe. Site evidences the seven liberal arts and primary sources plus integrated humanities; wonder is implicit but not explicitly named.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage: 0.75 (three of four emphases clearly present)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Substantial alignment to classical content and structure via Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, humanities, and primary sources.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

1) Keywords found:

- Positive terms sought: Socratic/seminar/dialectic; chanting/recitation; restful learning/scholé; rhetoric speeches/capstones. Not explicitly present on public pages.
- Negative signals: one Summer Program marketing page highlights “hands□on activities” and “STEM & engineering challenges,” language that maps to weaker negative signals in the lexicon when it eclipses classical methods (note: this appears in summer offerings, not core K□12 academics).

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive indicators absent in public copy: Socratic dialogue, restful learning, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation.
- Negative indicators present (light, peripheral): “hands□on”/“STEM challenges” in a camp context (not determinative of school□year pedagogy).

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 1
- Percent positive: 0.00; Percent coverage: 0.00

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Likely practice exists but is not yet documented. The summer page includes modern enrichment language; however, absence of explicit Socratic/chanting/restful cues on academic pages is the real limiting factor for this category.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found:

- Positive matches: teachers “mature in their Christian faith,” “gifted in teaching children,” “enthusiastic for classical education”; “teaching audition” (suggests master□teacher model/quality).

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive list: teachers as models of virtue; mentorship/collegiality. Public copy supports virtue/alignment but does not yet speak to “mentor/collegium/faculty of friends” explicitly.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 3; Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage: 0.50

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Strong faith/classical alignment in hiring; articulate the “teacher as mentor/living curriculum” and collegial formation to reach full mark.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found:

- Positive matches: “partner with parents” (parental primacy/partnership emphasis).
- Missing/limited: explicit “parent formation” (book groups/seminars), “open campus” invites.

2) Comparison to Six Elements:

- Positive indicators include parent partnership/co-educators; formation of affections; cultural transmission. Partnership is clear; other practices aren't yet detailed in public materials.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00; Percent coverage: 0.33

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Partnership is explicit; add parent-formation offerings and community practices to strengthen this category.

Aggregate Assessment

Overall rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale summary: - Clear classical Christian foundations (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations = CLASSICAL) with a robust articulation of classical purposes (Purpose/Goal = CLASSICAL) and an unusually strong public statement of the classical curriculum (Curriculum = CLASSICAL). - Public documentation is thinner for pedagogy (Socratic/chanting/restful learning), faculty formation language, and parent-formation/community practices; these are the only items keeping the school from an easy "CLASSICAL" on its face. Keyword framework used: Six Elements positive/negative indicators and lexicon checklists (e.g., Socratic, scholé, chanting, Great Books, etc.).

What would move the needle (to CLASSICAL on public evidence)

Prioritize adding/clarifying the following on the website (and in parent/faculty materials) using explicit, classical keywords drawn from the Six Elements list: - Pedagogy: Name and describe Socratic seminars/dialectic, upper-school rhetoric orations/capstones, K-6 chanting/recitation/memory work, and restful learning/scholé rhythms; include photos/program highlights and sample prompts. - Great Books: Add a representative reading list and language about engaging primary texts and the "Great Conversation". - Faculty: Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" and "Portrait of a Graduate," mentorship/collegium language, and faculty formation in classical pedagogy. - Parents/Community: Add "parent formation" offerings (book clubs/seminars) and language about partnering with parents as co-educators; highlight communal/feast-day events if present. - Worship/Liturgy (if applicable): Name chapel/morning prayer/hymnody to complete Element 1's liturgical dimension.

DETAILED KEYWORD TALLIES BY CATEGORY (from public site vs. Six Elements lists)

- Religious/Metaphysical: +10/-0 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, God, Scripture integrated, reverence, order/beauty of creation, classical tradition) → 67% coverage of sub-areas (no liturgy).
- Purpose/Goal: +6/-0 (virtue, wisdom, formation, truth/goodness/beauty aims) → 100% coverage.
- Curriculum: +12/-0 (Liberal Arts; Trivium/Quadrivium; arithmetic/geometry/music/cosmos; Latin; humanities; history/literature; primary sources) → 75% coverage (Great Books label missing).
- Pedagogy: +0/-1 (summer: "hands-on," "STEM & engineering challenges") → 0% coverage of classical methods in public academic pages.
- Faculty: +3/-0 (mature faith; gifted teachers; enthusiastic for classical education; audition) → 50% coverage (mentor/collegium not yet explicit).

- Parents/Community: +2/-0 (“partner with parents,” mission alignment) → 33% coverage (parent formation/community events not documented).

Reference keyword frameworks and exemplars used for scoring: - Six Elements positive/negative keyword indicators (religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, parents/community). - Classicality lexicon v2.2 (term lists by category).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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